

Four Things I Write Down After Every Call

Twelve years of an independent book of business rests on this habit. It takes ninety seconds.

"Buyer is interested" is not a note. It is a feeling you will not remember in a week. These four turn a conversation into an asset.

THE ONE RULE

Write it before the next call starts. Notes you intend to write later are notes you do not have.

1 The problem, in their words, with a number on it

- Quote them. Their language, not your summary. You will reuse those exact words in the follow-up and the proposal.
- Attach the cost in **time or money**. "Five hours a week on manual reporting, wants it halved by Q3" is a note. "Wants efficiency" is nothing.
- If you cannot put a number on the problem, you did not finish discovery.

2 Who else has to say yes

- Names and roles, not "the team." One person who likes you is not a deal.
- Note who controls the money, who blocks, and who you have not met yet.
- Re-check every few weeks. People change roles and leave, and a stale contact costs you the account. I nearly burned one that way.

3 The objection, quoted exactly

- Write the real words, including the awkward ones. Softening it means you prepare for an easier objection than the one coming.
- Tag it so you can see the pattern: price, timing, authority, trust, or fit.
- No objection at all is also the note. It usually means polite, not convinced.

4 The next step: who, what, by when

- A note without a next step is a dead end. Every entry closes with an action, an owner, and a date.
- Write both sides: what **you** send, and what **they** agreed to do.
- "Follow up soon" is not a next step. "I send pricing Thursday, she takes it to her director Monday" is. No agreed next step means the deal is not real yet.

Why this is the whole business

- Your book of business does not live in your CRM software. It lives in the quality of what you put into it.
- These notes are what let you reactivate a lead eighteen months later and sound like you remember them. Because you do.

Sources: Sybill, best way to take notes in a CRM 2026 · Salesmate · GoTranscript discovery-call note structure · Jamy AI. Minimum viable note: problem, impact, stakeholders, objection, next step with owner and date.